



6 280100 002394

FRIDAY

SEPTEMBER 18, 2026
RABI AL THANI 7, 1448

TRUSTED NEWS SINCE 1978

GULF NEWS

gulfnews.com



LIVE
UPDATES



UAE Presidential Court

UAE, SENEGAL PRESIDENTS DISCUSS WAYS TO STRENGTHEN TIES

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan yesterday received Bassirou Diomaye Faye, President of Senegal. The leaders discussed various aspects of UAE-Senegal relations and opportunities to further strengthen ties, particularly in the fields of investment, the economy and development, in support of their shared development ambitions. The meeting also addressed the 2026 UN Water Conference, to be co-hosted by the UAE and Senegal at the end of this year.

Borrowing costs moving higher again in the UAE after Fed hike

Higher rates may affect mortgages, new loans and savings

DUBAI

BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Borrowing costs are moving higher again in the UAE after the Central Bank raised its base rate by 25 basis points to 3.9 per cent, following the US Federal Reserve's first rate increase since 2023. The new rate took effect yesterday, up from 3.65 per cent.

The impact, for residents, will depend on what type of loan they hold and whether the rate is fixed or variable. Mortgage borrowers with variable rates could see repayments rise when their loans are next reviewed, while those

3.9%

is the current base rate after CBUAE's increase

on fixed-rate deals are protected until that period ends.

People taking out new mortgages, car loans or personal loans could also face higher borrowing costs, although banks will continue to set their own rates and offers.

Existing fixed-rate loans will not automatically become more expensive because the terms were agreed when the loan was taken out.

The same applies to credit cards, where rates and charges depend on the terms set by individual banks.

Higher rates may, however, bring some relief for savers.

Banks could offer better returns on savings accounts and fixed deposits, although any increase will depend on how each lender prices its products.

Raised by 25 basis points

The UAE move followed the Federal Reserve's decision to raise its benchmark rate by 25 basis points to a range of 3.75 per cent to 4.00 per cent as it continues to tackle inflation that remains above its 2 per cent target.

The CBUAE Base Rate is linked to a key US Federal Reserve rate, which means changes in US monetary policy are typically followed by adjustments in the UAE.

The main things to check now are whether existing loans are fixed or variable, when mortgage rates are next reviewed and whether banks begin changing rates on new borrowing and deposits.

SEE ALSO P-I

Buckingham Palace hits back at Diana book claims

Late princess' brother accuses Charles

LONDON

Buckingham Palace has denied a claim by the brother of the late Princess Diana that King Charles III said she would soon be forgotten after her death.

In a new book, Charles Spencer recounts the traumatic days after Diana was killed in a car crash in Paris in 1997 at the age of 36. He alleges that he argued with the then-Prince Charles, Diana's estranged husband, over palace plans for Prince William and Prince Harry to walk behind her coffin during the funeral procession.

Spencer says he told the now-king that Diana would not have wanted her sons, then aged 15 and 12, to undergo the ordeal. He claims Charles told him: "rest assured, we'll forget her soon enough." He accuses Charles of having "contempt" for his

ex-wife. Buckingham Palace responded Wednesday with a strong statement by the measured standards of the royal household.

'Pain of fraternal grief'

"While we do not comment on books as a matter of principle, His Majesty is mindful that the pain of fraternal grief can cloud reason, affect judgment and colour memory in ways others do not recognise, even many years after such a loss," it said.

Tensions between the palace and Diana's aristocratic Spencer relatives after her death have been much discussed, and dramatised in the film *The Queen* and TV series *The Crown*. *Swan Song: Diana, My Sister* is due to be published next week. The *Daily Mail* published the first in a series of extracts on Wednesday.

— AP

UAE BACKS DETERRENCE AND DIALOGUE WITH IRAN: GARGASH

De-escalation must for new regional future

DUBAI

BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

The UAE will combine deterrence and defence of its sovereignty with dialogue with Iran while ensuring that regional tensions do not derail its economic and development agenda, Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, said yesterday.

Speaking at a session titled *Media Reinvented: Navigating an Era of Transformation*, at the Arab Media Summit in Dubai, Gargash said: "The UAE's current strategy centres on two parallel tracks: balancing immediate crisis management with long-term regional diplomacy and economic growth."

Geography and the region's deeply interconnected relationships made it necessary to look beyond the immediate confrontation, he said, adding that collapse of the previous regional security order required new understandings suited to the next phase.

Protecting nation first

Gargash said the UAE leadership's first commitment was to the country's sovereignty and its people and to taking the measures necessary to protect them. At the same time, the UAE would continue with its "geoeconomic" policy, maintaining its economic and development trajectory and engagement with countries around the world despite regional turbulence.

Gargash cited President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan's recent visit to

The UAE's current strategy centres on two parallel tracks: balancing immediate crisis management with long-term regional diplomacy and economic growth."

Dr Anwar Gargash

Germany as an example of Abu Dhabi's determination to ensure that the crisis did not obstruct its broader international and economic agenda.

He drew a distinction between maintaining a relationship with Iran and rebuilding trust. Geography, history and intertwined interests made communication and dialogue between Iran and Gulf states necessary, he said. But rebuilding trust would take "many years", given what he described as the major aggression faced by GCC countries. Dialogue, the diplomatic adviser added, should extend beyond day-to-day issues such as trade, aviation and shipping to more fundamental questions, including guarantees against attacks and arrangements capable of delivering long-term stability for both sides and the wider region.

Stopping the tensions

Gargash said the first requirement was to stop the tensions "in any form and by any means", arguing that negotiations over a new regional future could not proceed while threats and attacks continued. Asked what im-

mediate steps Iran should take, Gargash said Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian had himself publicly described Iran's attack on Gulf states as a "major mistake". Gargash characterised it as a strategic mistake that may have achieved short-term objectives but left Iran facing a more complicated long-term position.

He said Iranian decision-making circles needed to adopt a different approach towards Gulf states, beginning with an end to attacks against them. He also referred to the use of militias and attempts to impose a new reality in the Strait of Hormuz as issues that would need to be addressed.

Key role of neighbours

Gargash said neighbouring countries could play a role in helping Iran emerge from the crisis and in restoring economic and development prospects. Responding to Iranian accusations against the UAE, Gargash said the country had defended itself and would continue to do so, while also extending "the hand of friendship".

He also pointed to what he described as differing centres of decision-making in Iran, saying some statements reflected more headline currents. He said the late Iranian Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei had exercised the final say over Iranian decision-making for 37 years from 1989, and that it would be difficult for any single person or institution to inherit that position in the same way.

Gargash described the various decision-making circles in Iran not as being at war with one another, but as "divergent", which he said helped explain differences in rhetoric and positions emerging from Tehran.

SEE ALSO P6, P-III



FRIDAY

UAE business icon Anis Sajani on work routines, relationships and more

IN FOCUS

Abu Dhabi Book Fair celebrates the written word | P8-9

THE COLLECTIVE

ALL THAT GLITTERS
FESTIVE EDIT 2026

25-26TH SEPTEMBER 2026
RITZ-CARLTON, DIFC | 10AM - 8PM

431-88 | AAVIDI | ACHIN BINDLISH | AIKEYAH | AKANKSHA MAGO | ANI CLOTHING | ANUJ BHUTANI | APPAPOPO | ARCHANA SHAH | ASEEM KAPOOR | ASHTAR | AYKA HOME | BLING BY RUCHIKA | CURATE HOME | DEEPIKA ANAND | DHAAGA & CO. | DOT | EZRA | GIFT WRAP ETC | GODDESS OF GLOCAL | GRAINE | HAZOORILAL LEGACY | ISHAAVVI | ISHARYA | JAJAABOR | JOOLRY BY KARISHMA MEHRA | JORAH MEN | JR JEWELRY | KAVYA SINGH KUNDU | KANIKA GOYAL LABEL | KHUSHBOO BAGRI | KHUSHBU RATHOD LABEL | KHYATI RUGHANI | KUMUD DESIGNS | LABEL RM | MADZIN | MINI SONDHI | MINIME ORGANICS | NACHIKET BARVE | NANDITA BIST | NAVIRAH | NIDHI YASHA | NIKU | NOTHING TO WEAR | NUPUR KANOI | PARUL AND PREYANKA | POOJA RAJGARHIA GUPTA | PRANAY BAIDYA | PREEVIN | PRIVATE COLLECTIONS | PUNIT BALANA | RAJAT TANGRI | RAJI RAMNIQ | SAHIB DANG | SAMEER PATEL | SARTORIAL BY SWATI | SHAVETA & ANUJ | SHRUTI JALAN | SIDDHARTHA BANSAL | SIMRAN CHHABRA JEWELS | STUDIO EARTH | STUDIO22 | SUKRITI AND AKRITI | SVA BY SONAM & PARAS MODI | TAANGERINE TIGER | TASUVURE | TRESOR | TRUFFLE HOUSE | URMIL BY RITIKA & PRERNA | VAROIN MARWAH | VEDANGI AGARWAL | VIBRANCE BY ANANYA | VIKRAM PHADNIS | VIVINIA BY VIDHI MEHRA | YVR LUXE

thecollective.dubai

dxbtcollective@gmail.com

+971589365239

VALET PARKING AVAILABLE